Errata

On Coppock and Green (2022), *The Journal of Politics* 84(2)

This note lists eleven misstatements in "Do Belief Systems Exhibit Dynamic Constraint?", published in *The Journal of Politics* 84(2), 725–738, doi 10.1086/716294. **None of them changes a conclusion of the article.** The finding that treatments which move a target attitude leave nontarget attitudes untouched is unaffected: the pooled indirect effect is small and statistically indistinguishable from zero on either the published figure or the corrected one, and every estimate in tables 1 through 4 reproduces exactly.

The first two are the same pooled ratio, printed with the wrong sign in the results section and again in the discussion. The next two attach real estimates to the wrong sample. Four more are counts and roundings that disagree with the article's own tables. The last supplies two cross-references the appendix omits.

Every corrected value below is computed from the deposited data at the time this document is rendered; bold marks the tokens that change. The interval endpoints quoted alongside a corrected point estimate are left exactly as the article prints them, because each is one draw of an unseeded bootstrap and every one of them falls inside the range that bootstrap produces. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/coppock_green_2022.

1. The sign of the pooled ratio

> If we pool the three studies together, our estimate is 1.4% (95% CI: -8%, 6%).

Corrected:

> If we pool the three studies together, our estimate is **-1.7%** (95% CI: -8%, 6%).

The three inputs are the sample-specific ratios of the precision-weighted average nontarget effect to the precision-weighted average target effect: 0.8% on MTurk, 6.4% among elites and -9.4% on Lucid. The deposited `in_text_numbers.R` pools them with `rmeta::meta.summaries`, which passes no `method` argument and is therefore an inverse-variance fixed-effect meta-analysis. Two of the three inputs are near zero and the third is negative with the second-smallest standard error, so no pooling at these weights can land above zero; running the deposited code today gives -2.8%. The published interval

endpoints are left as printed because they fall inside the range the unseeded bootstrap produces, which the point estimate does not: over repeated runs at the resample count the deposit ships, the pooled estimate lies between -5.1% and 0.4%.

2. The same ratio in the discussion

> But in only nine of 144 opportunities did it induce significant changes on nontarget issues, and the average spillover effect is just 1.4% of the first-stage direct effect.

Corrected:

> But in only nine of 144 opportunities did it induce significant changes on nontarget issues, and the average spillover effect is just **-1.7%** of the first-stage direct effect.

The same quantity as item 1, restated. The counts in the sentence are correct.

3. The number of nontarget questions in study 2

> Responses to these nontarget outcomes are positively correlated among each other and with the target outcome of the manipulation (correlations range from 0.3 to 0.7), so it is reasonable to imagine that subjects would apply the religious conviction consideration when answering the three further questions.

Corrected:

> Responses to these nontarget outcomes are positively correlated among each other and with the target outcome of the manipulation (correlations range from 0.3 to 0.7), so it is reasonable to imagine that subjects would apply the religious conviction consideration when answering the **four** further questions.

Table 2 reports four nontarget outcomes, and the results paragraph two paragraphs later calls them "the four additional outcome measures". The design sentence before this one groups them into three topics rather than counting the questions, describing one measure that raises the religious objection in another domain and "the other two outcome measures" covering same-sex marriage and school prayer; school prayer is measured with two questions, not one. The stated correlation range is correct: the ten pairwise correlations in the original sample run from 0.26 to 0.65.

4. The MTurk within-domain correlation

> On MTurk, the average correlation between attitudes in the same domain was smaller at 0.29, and the average correlation between attitudes in different domains was very small at 0.06.

Corrected:

> On MTurk, the average correlation between attitudes in the same domain was smaller at **0.30**, and the average correlation between attitudes in different domains was very small at 0.06.

The quantity is 0.2966. Table 1 prints .30 for it, so the table rounds it correctly and the sentence does not.

5. The graduate degree shares

> A full 96% of the elite sample hold a college degree, compared with 51% of the MTurk sample and 44% of the Lucid sample; 71% of the elites hold a graduate degree, compared with 13% for the MTurk sample and 15% for Lucid.

Corrected:

> A full 96% of the elite sample hold a college degree, compared with 51% of the MTurk sample and 44% of the Lucid sample; **72%** of the elites hold a graduate degree, compared with **12%** for the MTurk sample and 15% for Lucid.

Appendix table B.2 prints 71.6% and 12.4% for the same two categories, so the sentence truncates the first and rounds the second the wrong way. The three college-degree shares, which appear in no table, are 96.5%, 51.4% and 44.5% and hold as printed.

6. A standard error in study 3

> By contrast, the effects on economic system justification are small and close to zero: -0.18 standard units in the original study (SE: 0.10) and -0.07 units in the replication (SE: 0.06).

Corrected:

> By contrast, the effects on economic system justification are small and close to zero: -0.18 standard units in the original study (SE: 0.10) and -0.07 units in the replication (SE: **0.07**).

Table 3 prints 0.066 for the same standard error. As in item 5, the sentence truncates where the table rounds.

7. The sample the inconsistency rates come from

> As is well documented (Ahler and Broockman 2018; Sears and Citrin 1982), inconsistency between preferences for smaller government and increased social spending is common. Among the MTurk sample, 30% of the respondents were inconsistent; this figure was 24% on Lucid.

Corrected:

> As is well documented (Ahler and Broockman 2018; Sears and Citrin 1982), inconsistency between preferences for smaller government and increased social spending is common. Among the **study 2 original** sample, 30% of the respondents were inconsistent; this figure was 24% **in the replication**.

Both figures come from study 2, and both study 2 samples were recruited on Lucid: the body text says the 1,087 subjects for that experiment "were also recruited via Lucid", and appendix table C.3 heads its two columns "Lucid Original" and "Lucid Replication". The indicator that defines inconsistency appears in no MTurk data file in the deposit. Table 4 carries the same mislabel in its row heading "N (MTurk)"; its cells are correct and it is not reprinted here.

8. The sample the correction effects come from

> The results are shown in table 4. When induced to become more consistent, people who prefer smaller government prefer less spending (-0.172 scale points on MTurk, -0.153 scale points on Lucid).

Corrected:

> The results are shown in table 4. When induced to become more consistent, people who prefer smaller government prefer less spending (-0.172 scale points **in the original Lucid sample**, -0.153 scale points **in the Lucid replication**).

The same mislabel as item 7. Table 4's top panel is fitted on the study 2 original sample, the same 1,087 Lucid respondents table 2's top panel uses and appendix table C.3's first column describes.

9. The figures section B.4 does not name

> Figures show that while the treatment effects on target issues remain significant even a full month after treatment, the effects on nontarget issues remain very close to zero over time.

Corrected:

> **Figures B.2 and B.3** show that while the treatment effects on target issues remain significant even a full month after treatment, the effects on nontarget issues remain very close to zero over time.

The sentence refers to figures and names none. Section B.4 has exactly two, and they are the two the sentence describes: Figure B.2 gives the estimates ten days after treatment and Figure B.3 the estimates thirty days after, which is the full month the sentence appeals to. The omission is in the authors' own appendix source as well as on the published page, and the two numbers are the only words this adds.

10. The table section A.2 cites for the 32 graphs

> These three edges blow up the possible number of graphs from the 32 in Table 1 to 256.

Corrected:

> These three edges blow up the possible number of graphs from the 32 in **Table A.1** to 256.

The 32 graphs are enumerated in appendix Table A.1. Table 1 of the article reports levels of static constraint and enumerates nothing. The count is right and the reference points at the wrong table; as with entry 9, the slip is in the authors' own appendix source as well as on the published page.

11. A significance threshold stated as a percentage

> The effect of the prime on subsequent support for government reducing income gaps is slightly negative and is not significant at the 0.05% level in either sample.

Corrected:

> The effect of the prime on subsequent support for government reducing income gaps is slightly negative and is not significant at the **0.05** level in either sample.

The article's tables mark significance at $p < .05$ throughout, and a 0.05% level would be $p < .0005$, a threshold the article uses nowhere. The claim the sentence makes holds at the 0.05 level: Table C.4 gives $p = 0.064$ in the original sample and $p = 0.097$ in the replication. Only the unit on the threshold is wrong.